[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Gulfa, Ispahan, August 12, 1840*

I enclose a letter for my Uncle and Aunt Smith.

It appears to me that my fair cousin and you are rather severe upon uncle and aunt [Smith] about this same nigger, having no children of their own that they should adopt one is the most natural thing in the world, people must have something to fix their affections on. Their having bought this blackey is unlucky (for them I mean). If they had wanted an article of this description why not buy a Georgian or Circassian? To be sure they would have cost more, the price of the blacks in Egypt is I should think about four or five pounds, at least the bad ones, a Georgian or Circassian costs fifty or sixty, but then he could have been a sort of animal they could have adopted as their son and heir with credit. I owe them much for former kindness to me an ill mannered cub as I was in those days, and as long as I suppose that my letters please them I shall continue to write, when they do not I shall leave off. Surely they have a right to adopt either blacks or whites if it pleases them and we their nephews and nieces ought not to be vexed. The adoption of slaves is very common in this country but it is done after many years of faithful and affectionate servitude.

I hope to leave this in a few days for the camp when I shall again have to face the Shah and his minister without having any news whatever from Charles. You at home do not appear to understand the risk I am running; one angry word from the Shah or his minister and I have the prospect of a prison before me. A few lines from Charles to either H M or his minister would save me from this and this small favor he denies me. You tell me to believe that Charles thinks of me and wishes to come to Persia to releave me. I try to believe so, but his whole conduct proves to the contrary. If he had not one farthing in the world at least he could write to ask the Shah to be kind to me until he himself was able to come out here. Why has he detained the Shah's pistols, Major Rawlinsons[51] books, Coll Shie[l]'s[52] clothes, the detaining these things could do him no good and has had the effect of making every one mistrust him.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tabreez, June 15, 1841*

I received your kind letter of the 5th April from Philadelphia yesterday so you see it has gone very quickly. But please when you next write give me some American news. We are most anxious to learn how the affair of McCleod[53] has been settled, because in Europe they anticipated a war.

[51] The famous "father of Assyriology."

[52] Justin Shiel, listed in the British Army List for 1838, along with Major Rawlinson and other officers, as accredited to Persia.

[53] For a completely documented account of the McLeod affair, which seriously threatened to cause war between Britain and the United States, cf. the article by M. L. Bonham in *Journal of the New York State Historical Society*, v. 18, p. 189–217 (1937), "Alexander McLeod: Bone of Contention."

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